

↑
GOOD
news
 $\delta \geq 0$

LOW confidence
unsure ($C \rightarrow 0$)

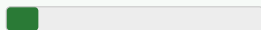
LEARN



$\alpha = \alpha_{\max}$ (large)

HIGH confidence
certain ($C \rightarrow 1$)

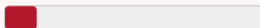
SHRUG



$\alpha = \alpha_{\min}$ (small)

↓
BAD
news
 $\delta < 0$

DISMISS



$\alpha = \alpha_{\min}$ (small)

REVISE



$\alpha = \alpha_{\max}$ (large)

optimistic

soaks up success, brushes off failure

revising

corrects on failure, discounts success

Confidence is a valence-gated learning gain: $\alpha(C) = \alpha_{\min} + (\alpha_{\max} - \alpha_{\min}) C$ on bad news, $\alpha_{\max} - (\alpha_{\max} - \alpha_{\min}) C$ on good news.

The same C has a second role: it is your *credibility* to neighbours, $w_i = C_i / \sum_j C_j$ — how much others learn from you.